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UNITED STATES MARINE CORPS
HEADQUARTERS MARINE CORPS (CODE [redacted])
RECORDS BRANCH, PERSONNEL DEPARTMENT

FILE NO. BO-I/[redacted]
EXTRACT 1 OF 1 PAGE 1 OF 1
PERIOD: JUL 1962 – DEC 1970

DECLASSIFIED
EXTRACT ONLY

BENSON, SAMUEL E. III

SERVICE RECORD (EXTRACT) // BOOK I: SLAP

SECTION 1. PERSONAL DATA

NAME (LAST, FIRST, MIDDLE)	SERVICE NUMBER	DATE OF BIRTH
BENSON, SAMUEL EDWARD III	[redacted]	23 JUL 1943
HOME OF RECORD	**RAISED**	**SCHOOL**
EAST RIVERTON, NEW JERSEY	CAMDEN, N.J.	PALMYRA HIGH SCHOOL, CLASS OF 1962
DATE / PLACE OF ENLISTMENT	**PRIMARY MOS**	**NEXT OF KIN**
2 JUL 1962 USMC	0311 RIFLEMAN	BENSON, AUDREY V. (WIFE)

SECTION 2. CHRONOLOGICAL RECORD OF SERVICE

DATE	UNIT / STATION	ENTRY
02 JUL 1962	MCRD PARRIS ISLAND, S.C.	Enlisted. Assigned 2d Recruit Training Bn, Platoon 2080.
AUG 1962	MCRD PARRIS ISLAND, S.C.	Qualified EXPERT, M14 rifle.
14 SEP 1962	MCRD PARRIS ISLAND, S.C.	Graduated recruit training, Platoon 2080. MOS 0311 assigned.
25 SEP 1962	ITR, CAMP GEIGER, N.C.	Joined Company B, Infantry Training Regiment.
01 OCT 1962	ITR, CAMP GEIGER, N.C.	Promoted Private First Class.
30 OCT 1962	ITR, CAMP GEIGER, N.C.	Completed ITR. 0311 confirmed. Orders to 2d MarDiv.
03 NOV 1962	CO C, 2D BN, 2D MARINES	Joined for duty, Camp Lejeune, N.C. Fleet rifle company.
03-21 JUN 1963	U.S. ARMY AIRBORNE SCHOOL	Fort Benning, Ga. Five jumps. Basic Parachutist.
02 JUL 1963	CO C, 2D BN, 2D MARINES	Promoted Lance Corporal.
DEC 1963	2D FORCE RECON CO	Ordered to reconnaissance training, Camp Lejeune.
JAN 1964	2D FORCE RECON CO	Met course standard. Assigned Team 3 ("Three-Romeo").
SPRING 1964	2D FORCE RECON CO	Qualified EXPERT, M1911A1 pistol.
MAY-JUN 1964	KEY WEST, FLA.	Advanced water training, Navy underwater swimmers.
SEP 1964	FORT BRAGG, N.C.	Developmental free-fall exposure. No qual. awarded.
01 MAR 1965	2D FORCE RECON CO	Promoted Corporal.
17 APR 1965	LANGLEY AFB CHAPEL, VA.	Married Audrey Virginia Cotton.
SEP 1965	1ST FORCE RECON CO, RVN	Arrived Da Nang, Republic of Vietnam.
01 FEB 1966	1ST FORCE RECON CO, RVN	Promoted Sergeant.
1966-1967	1ST FORCE RECON CO, RVN	Long-range patrols, Que Son Mtns / Que Son Valley.
1968	1ST FORCE RECON CO, RVN	Tet Offensive. Phu Bai – Hue area. Call sign GHOST ONE.
1970	1ST FORCE RECON CO, RVN	Departed RVN. Company stood down, Aug 1970.

SECTION 3. QUALIFICATIONS / BADGES

- Rifle Expert Badge (M14), Parris Island, 1962
- Pistol Expert Badge (M1911A1), 1964
- Basic Parachutist Insignia, Fort Benning, 1963
- Reconnaissance course, 2d Force Recon Co, 1964

SECTION 4. DECORATIONS

- National Defense Service Medal
- Further entries [redacted]
- [redacted]

SECTION 5. RANK HISTORY

- PVT 02 JUL 1962
- PFC 01 OCT 1962
- LCPL 02 JUL 1963
- CPL 01 MAR 1965
- SGT 01 FEB 1966 (rank at close of extract)

SECTION 6. DEPENDENTS

- Brian Keith, son, b. 14 JAN 1966
- Tanya, daughter, b. 27 APR 1967
- Sean Tyrone, son, b. 05 DEC 1970

SECTION 7. REMARKS

Known to family as "Sammy." Known in the Marine Corps as "Benson." Called "Ben" by his wife and the Cotton family since 10 NOV 1962. Tactical call sign GHOST ONE, northern I Corps, 1968. Informal name "SLAP" acquired after return from RVN, 1970. Not of record. Subject discourages its use. [redacted]

RECORD CONTINUES IN BLACK OPS: GHOST.

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CERTIFIED EXTRACT